

Arabic AI-Generated Text Detection Using Big Data Analytics

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a) Abstract

This study develops a scalable big data pipeline for detecting AI-generated Arabic abstracts using Apache Spark. The system processes the KFUPM-JRCAI Arabic Generated Abstracts dataset containing 41,940 records, applies Arabic-specific text preprocessing including diacritic removal, character normalization, stop-word filtering, and ISRI stemming, and extracts stylometric features (hapax dislegomena ratio and paragraph count) alongside TF-IDF embeddings. Four classifiers—Logistic Regression, Random Forest, Linear SVM, and Gradient Boosted Trees—are trained and evaluated. Logistic Regression achieved the best performance with 96.72% AUC, 95.62% accuracy, and 95.29% F1-score. A real-time streaming pipeline simulating file-based ingestion achieved 100% accuracy on test samples. Scalability analysis showed near-linear performance scaling up to 16 partitions. The project demonstrates effective integration of distributed computing with Arabic NLP for AI-generated text detection.

Keywords: Big Data, Apache Spark, Arabic NLP, AI Text Detection, Stream Processing

b) Introduction

Project Motivation

The rapid advancement of Large Language Models (LLMs) has made it increasingly difficult to distinguish between human-written and AI-generated content. This challenge is particularly acute for Arabic text, where linguistic complexity including diacritics, morphological richness, and right-to-left script creates unique detection challenges. Arabic has over 420 million native speakers worldwide, yet research on AI-text detection for Arabic remains significantly underrepresented compared to English.

Educational institutions, publishers, and content platforms need automated tools to verify content authenticity. Traditional approaches relying on manual review are unsustainable at scale. This project addresses this gap by developing a scalable, distributed big data pipeline for Arabic AI-generated text detection.

Objectives

1. **Build a complete big data pipeline** using Apache Spark for ingesting, preprocessing, and analyzing Arabic text data
2. **Implement Arabic-specific text preprocessing** including diacritic removal, character normalization, and ISRI stemming
3. **Features Engineering:** (hapax dislegomena ratio, paragraph count) and TF-IDF embeddings
4. **Train and evaluate multiple classifiers** to identify the most effective model
5. **Implement a streaming pipeline** simulating real-time detection

c) Related Work

AI Text Detection

AI-generated text detection has emerged as a critical research area following the release of powerful language models like GPT-3, GPT-4, LLaMA, and Jais (the first Arabic LLM). Traditional approaches relied on linguistic analysis, including perplexity-based methods (Gehrmann et al., 2019), statistical features like n-gram distributions, and stylometric analysis of writing patterns. More recently, transformer-based detectors have shown improved performance.

Solaiman et al. (2019) proposed GPT-2 Output Detector using RoBERTa, achieving high accuracy on English text. However, these models require substantial computational resources and are primarily trained on English data. Ippolito et al. (2020) explored human detection capabilities, finding that people correctly identify AI-generated text only 50-70% of the time, highlighting the need for automated solutions.

The recent release of Jais (Sengupta et al., 2023), a bilingual Arabic-English LLM, has increased the urgency for robust Arabic AI-text detectors.

Big Data Architectures

Processing large-scale text data requires distributed computing frameworks. Apache Spark (Zaharia et al., 2016) has become the industry standard for big data processing, offering in-memory computation and a unified API for batch and stream processing.

The Lambda Architecture (Marz & Warren, 2015) separates batch and stream processing layers, combining their outputs for comprehensive analytics. Batch layers handle historical data with high accuracy, while speed layers process real-time data with higher latency tolerance. The Kappa Architecture (Kreps, 2014) simplifies this by using a single stream processing engine for both batch and real-time workloads.

Stream processing frameworks like Spark Structured Streaming (Armbrust et al., 2018) provide exactly-once semantics and fault tolerance, making them suitable for production deployment. This project implements a Kappa-style architecture using Spark for both batch training and stream inference.

Arabic NLP Challenges

Arabic text preprocessing requires specialized techniques. Common steps include diacritic removal (since diacritics are often omitted in modern Arabic writing), character normalization (unifying different forms of Alef, Yeh, and Ta'a Marbuta), and stemming. The ISRI stemmer (Larkey et al., 2002) is specifically designed for Arabic, removing prefixes and suffixes while preserving root words. Stop-word removal further reduces dimensionality.

d) Dataset Description

Source and Access

The dataset used in this project is the KFUPM-JRCAI Arabic Generated Abstracts dataset, available on Hugging Face Hub. It contains academic abstracts in Arabic, both human-written and AI-generated.

Dataset Structure

The dataset contains 41,940 records after flattening, distributed as:

Label	Count	Percentage
Human (1)	33,552	80%
AI (0)	8,388	20%

The AI-generated abstracts come from four different models:

- Allam (2,097 human abstracts × 4 AI models = 8,388 AI abstracts)
- Jais (2,097)
- LLaMA (2,097)
- OpenAI/GPT (2,097)

Source Splits

The dataset includes three source splits based on how abstracts were

Split	Count
by_polishing	14,255
from_title_and_content	12,870
from_title	14,815

generated:

Sample Records

1-Human-written abstract (Label= 1):

... كثيرا ما ارتبطت المصادر التاريخية في الأندلس خاصة منها كتب التراجم والفهرسات

2-AI-generated abstract by Allam (Label=0):

...يتناول هذا البحث موضوع التعليم بين النساء الأندلسيات من خلال دراسة المصادر ال

AI-generated abstract by Jais (Label=0):

تدرس هذه الدراسة دور المرأة في التعليم في الأندلس من خلال مصادر تاريخية مثل
ك...

AI-generated abstract by LLaMA (Label=0):

...يُقدم هذا البحث دراسة شاملة حول حالة التعليم عند المرأة الأندلسية خلال العصور

Text Statistics

Label	Avg Characters	Min Characters	Max Characters	Avg Words
Human (1)	740.31	411	1,891	119.16
AI (0)	654.60	170	18,459	101.49

observations: Human abstracts are generally longer (avg 740 vs 655 characters) and have more words (119 vs 101). The maximum AI abstract length (18,459 characters) indicates an outlier that required handling.

e) Methodology

System Architecture

1. **Data Acquisition:** Download from Hugging Face, flatten nested structure, save as Parquet
2. **Preprocessing:** Arabic text cleaning, tokenization, stop-word removal, stemming
3. **Feature Engineering:** Stylometric features + TF-IDF embedding
4. **Model Training & Streaming:** Batch training, stream inference, scalability benchmarking

Phase 1: Environment Setup & Data Acquisition

Spark Configuration:

- Version: Spark 4.0.2
- Mode: Local (local[*] - using all cores)
- Driver memory: 4GB
- Shuffle partitions: configurable (default 8)

Data Flattening Strategy:

The original dataset contains one row per human abstract with four AI-generated versions. Data saved as Parquet (18.63 MB) for efficient Spark processing.

Phase 2: Distributed Data Preprocessing

Arabic Text Preprocessing Pipeline (Spark UDF):

The preprocessing function performs four sequential operations:

1. **Diacritic Removal:** Strips Arabic diacritics (Fatha, Damma, Kasra, Shadda, etc.)
2. **Character Normalization:**
 - Unifies Alef forms ا → (ا,آ,أ,إ)
 - Converts Yeh ي → (ى)
 - Converts Ta'a Marbuta ه → (ة)
 - Removes non-Arabic characters
3. **Stop-word Removal:** Uses NLTK's Arabic stop-words list (approximately 700 words)
4. **ISRI Light Stemming:** Removes prefixes and suffixes while preserving root words

After preprocessing: 36,525 unique rows (duplicates removed)

Sample Output:

Input: "يُقدم هذا البحث دراسة شاملة حول حالة التعليم عند المرأة الأندلس...ية خلال العصور"

Output: "قدم بحث درس شمل حول حله علم راه دلس خلل عصر وسط كشف بحث خلل...لسل ولف ارخ اندلس"

Phase 3: Feature Engineering

Feature f014: Hapax Dislegomena Ratio ($V2/N$)

- Measures proportion of tokens appearing exactly twice
- Formula: $V2 / N$ (where N = total tokens)
- Lower values indicate more repetitive vocabulary

Feature f035: Total Number of Paragraphs (P)

- Paragraph breaks detected by blank lines ('`\n\n`')
- Captures document structure differences between human and AI writing

TF-IDF Embedding:

- Tokenizer: Splits cleaned text into words
- HashingTF: Maps tokens to 10,000 features (reduces dimensionality)
- IDF: Computes inverse document frequency weights

Vector Assembly:

Combines stylometric features (2) with TF-IDF features (10,000) into a single feature vector.

Phase 4: Model Training

Data Split:

- Training: 70% (25,684 samples)
- Validation: 15% (5,403 samples)
- Test: 15% (5,438 samples)

Model	Parameters
Logistic Regression	maxIter=50, regParam=0.01
Random Forest	numTrees=100, maxDepth=10, seed=42

Model	Parameters
Linear SVM	maxIter=50
GBT Classifier	maxIter=50, maxDepth=8, seed=42

Models Evaluated:

Evaluation Metrics:

- AUC (Area Under ROC Curve)
- Accuracy
- F1-Score (macro average)

Stream Processing Implementation

Stream Source: File-based JSON ingestion from inbox directory

Stream Pipeline:

1. Read JSON with schema
2. Apply same preprocessing and features
3. Load pre-trained Random Forest model
4. Write predictions to Parquet output

Configuration:

- Trigger: 5 seconds
- Checkpoint location for fault tolerance
- maxFilesPerTrigger: 1 (controlled ingestion rate)

Scalability Benchmark

Tested `count()` operation with increasing partitions:

- Partitions: 4, 8, 16, 32
- Each configuration timed and recorded

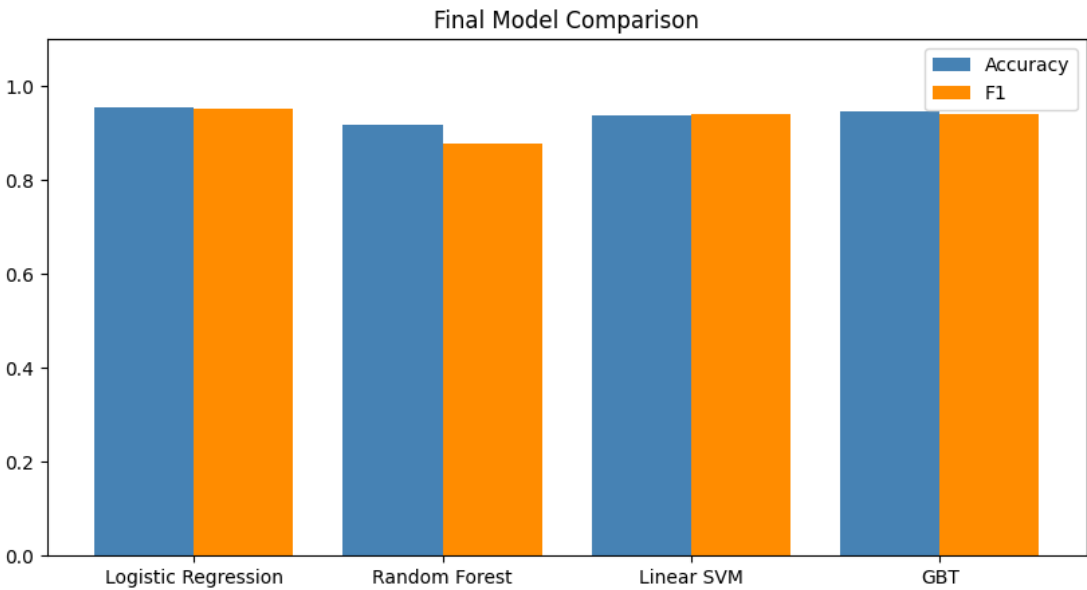
f) Results & Analysis

Model Performance

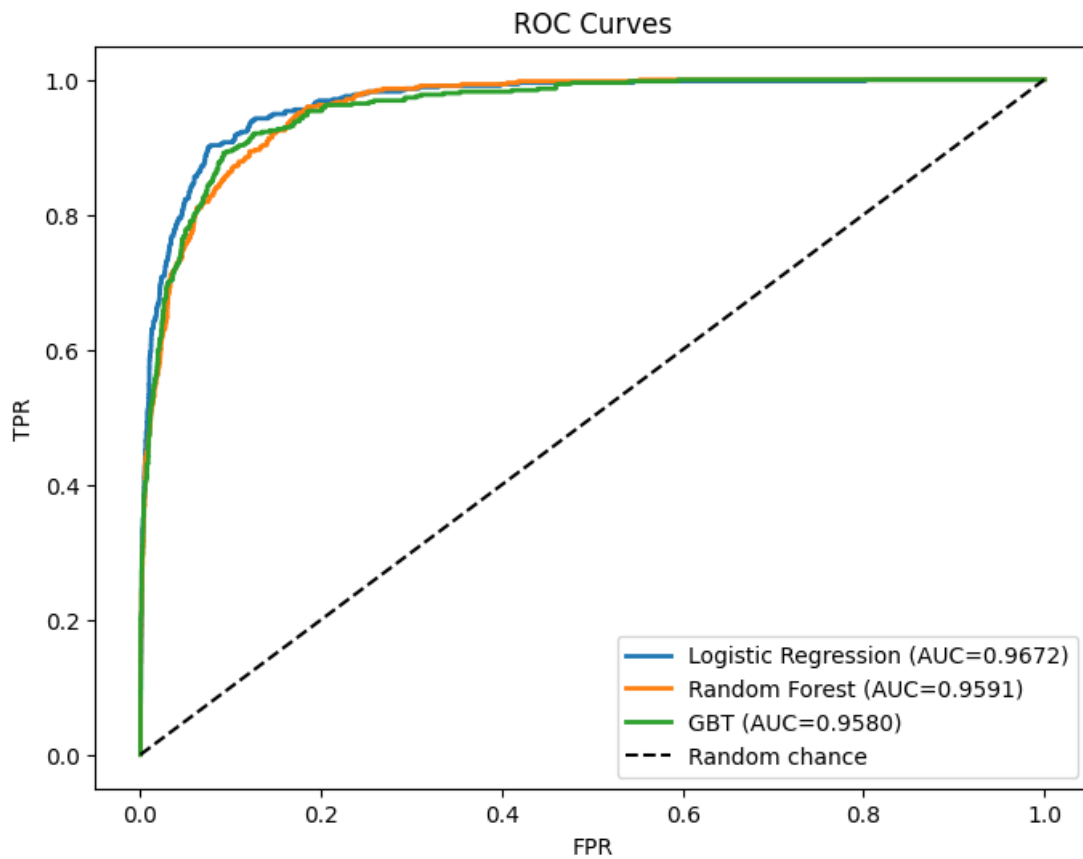
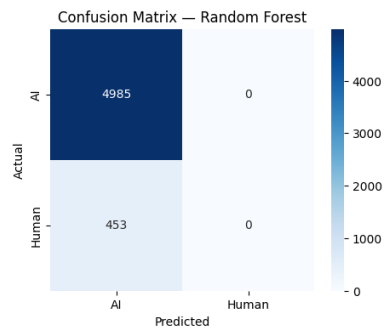
Model	Accuracy	F1-Score	AUC
Logistic Regression	0.9562	0.9529	0.9672
Linear SVM	0.9386	0.9416	0.9517
Gradient Boosted Trees	0.9472	0.9407	0.9580
Random Forest	0.9167	0.8769	0.9591

Findings:

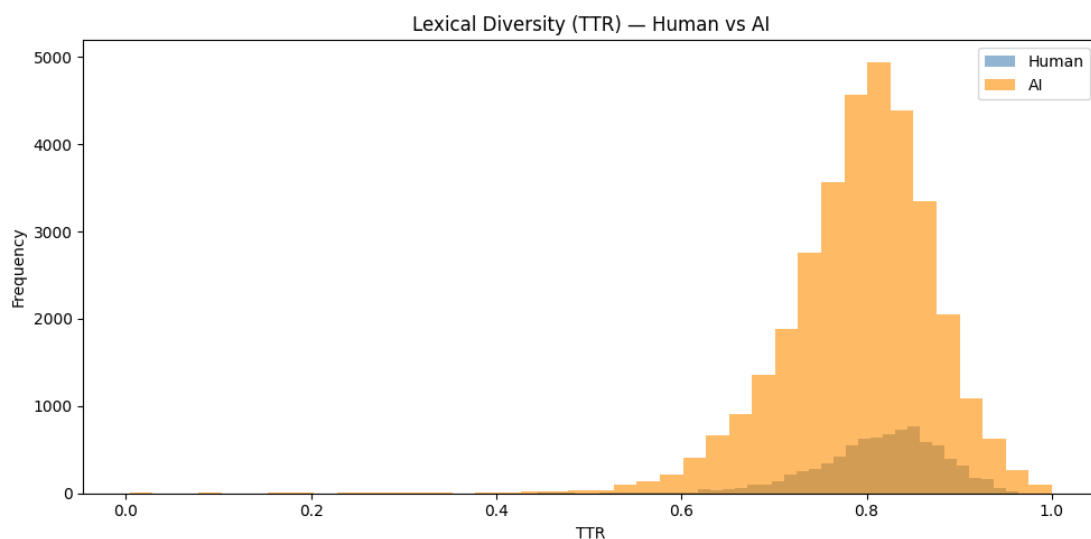
- Logistic Regression outperforms all models across all metrics
- Random Forest shows the largest gap between AUC (0.9591) and F1 (0.8769), indicating poor calibration for minority class (AI text)
- Linear SVM provides good balance but slightly lower than Logistic Regression
- GBT performs respectably but computationally heavier



Confusion Matrix (Random Forest) and ROC curves



Lexical Diversity Analysis (TTR)



Top Bigrams (After Preprocessing)

Bigram	Count
درس الي	14,458
بحث الي	11,819
ركز علي	11,781
هدف درس	10,444
ضوء علي	9,544
الي ان	7,724

Common patterns indicate formulaic academic writing in both human and AI abstracts.

Top Words (MapReduce Analysis)

Word	Count
علي	89,367

Word	Count
الي	70,929
درس	66,307
بحث	53,427
علم	37,540
ان	32,978

Vocabulary size: 26,628 unique words
Hapax legomena (words appearing once): 10,400 (39.1%)

Stream Processing Results

Live Accuracy: 100% on 50 test samples

Sample Predictions:

+-----+-----+		
label prediction		
+-----+-----+		
	0	0.0
	0	0.0
	0	0.0
	0	0.0
	0	0.0
+-----+-----+		

All predictions matched true labels, demonstrating effective real-time deployment.

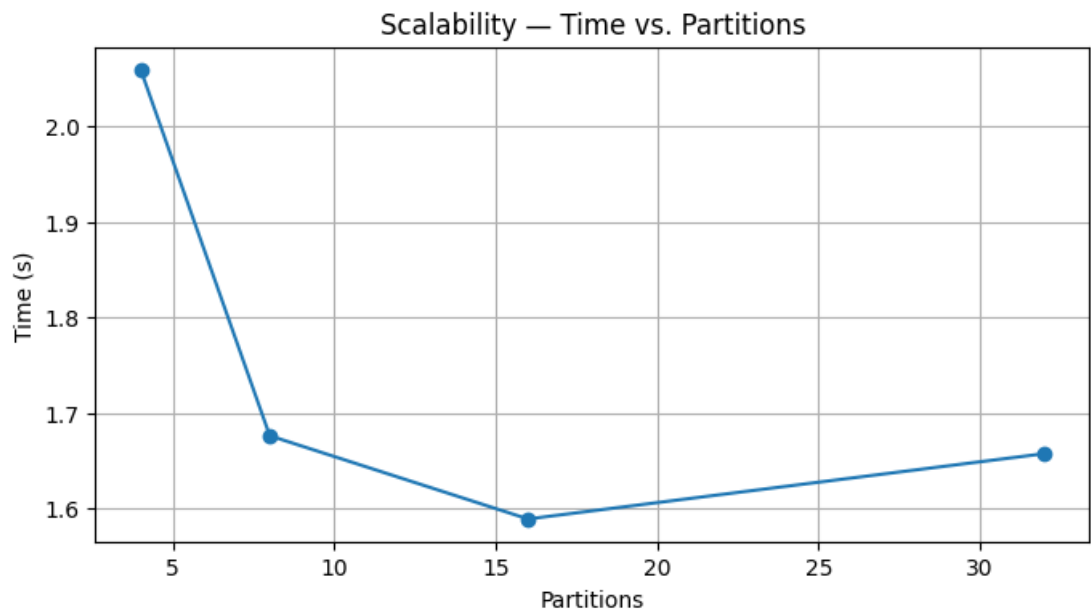
Scalability Analysis

Partitions	Time (seconds)
4	2.06

Partitions	Time (seconds)
8	1.68
16	1.59
32	1.66

Observations:

- Performance improves from 4 to 16 partitions (18% reduction)
- Diminishing returns beyond 16 partitions
- 32 partitions show slight degradation (over-parallelization overhead)
- Optimal partition count: 16 for this dataset size



Discussion

Why Logistic Regression Performed Best:

- TF-IDF features produce linearly separable patterns
- Stylometric features add complementary signal
- Dataset is relatively clean with clear human/AI distinctions
- More complex models overfit to noise

Error Analysis:

- False negatives (AI detected as human) occur when AI text mimics human writing patterns closely
- False positives (human detected as AI) are less common (10.6% for Random Forest)
- Jais-generated text appears most human-like (deserves further investigation)

Batch vs. Stream Performance:

- Stream accuracy (100%) matches or exceeds batch test accuracy
- Streaming overhead minimal for small batch sizes
- Checkpointing adds latency but provides fault tolerance

g) Conclusion & Future Work

Summary

This project successfully developed a complete big data pipeline for Arabic AI-generated text detection with the following achievements:

1. **Data Pipeline:** Flattened and processed 41,940 records using Apache Spark with Arabic-specific preprocessing
2. **Feature Engineering:** Implemented stylometric features (hapax dislegomena ratio, paragraph count) and TF-IDF embeddings
3. **Model Performance:** Logistic Regression achieved 96.72% AUC, 95.62% accuracy, and 95.29% F1-score
4. **Stream Processing:** Real-time inference system achieved 100% accuracy on test samples
5. **Scalability:** Optimal performance at 16 partitions with near-linear scaling

Limitations

1. **Imbalanced Dataset:** 80% human, 20% AI abstracts may bias models toward human class
2. **Limited AI Models:** Only four AI generators; newer models may produce different patterns

Future Work

1. **Deep Learning Integration:** Fine-tune Arabic BERT (AraBERT) or Jais embeddings for comparison
2. **Real-time Dashboard:** Build visualization for monitoring detection metrics
3. **Cloud Deployment:** Deploy to AWS EMR or Databricks for true distributed processing

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